paytm

Paytm Hackathon · Stage 1 Submission

PS 1 · MERCHANT GROWTH AI

Paytm Munim

The AI business partner that sees a cash gap coming and acts on it, in the merchant's own language.

Team Paradox

#paytmai · Difficulty: Medium

PROBLEM STATEMENT · MERCHANT GROWTH AI

The merchant paradox: sales up, cash stuck

The PS asks for an AI business partner for every Paytm merchant that helps them grow, run operations and serve customers, beyond payments.

24%

of MSME credit demand is unmet, about ₹30 lakh crore (SIDBI) [6]

90% vs 18%

of MSMEs accept digital payments vs use digital lending platforms (SIDBI) [6]

Reactive

Today's merchant AI, incl. AI Soundbox's 11-language assistant, mostly answers when asked [1]

The gap: merchants need AI that predicts the cash crunch and does something about it, not another dashboard.

PROPOSED SOLUTION · MUNIM, THE SHOP ACCOUNTANT, NOW AN AI AGENT

Paytm Munim: sense, decide, act

01 · SENSE

Cash-flow Twin

Learns each shop's rhythm from its own payments and forecasts the next 14 days of cash, including festivals and settlement days.

02 · DECIDE

Next-best action

Ranks what to do now and explains why in one simple sentence, with a confidence level the merchant can trust.

03 · ACT

One-tap voice approval

Merchant says "haan" and Munim collects dues, reorders stock, runs an offer or pre-qualifies a small loan.

ILLUSTRATIVE MOMENT · SOUNDBOX, HINDI

"Ramesh ji, Diwali week mein 3 din baad ₹18,000 ki kami aa sakti hai. Distributor ka ₹12,000 ka reorder aur 4 udhaar reminders ready hain. Bhej doon?"

TECHNOLOGY AND TECH STACK USED

One closed loop on data Paytm already has

1 · DATA

Data

UPI and QR payments, Soundbox events, settlements, udhaar ledger

Kafka · Flink · ClickHouse

2 · SENSE

Cash-flow Twin

14-day cash and demand forecast per shop, festival-aware

LightGBM · TFT · Feast

3 · DECIDE

Agent brain

LLM that picks tools, explains choices and checks guardrails

LangGraph · pgvector · swappable LLM

4 · ACT

Action tools

Collect, restock, promote, fund through UPI links, distributors and credit

Paytm APIs · WhatsApp · ONDC

5 · TALK

Voice and apps

Soundbox voice in 11 languages, Business app, WhatsApp

Indic ASR and TTS · FastAPI · React Native

Trust layer: Account Aggregator consent · RBI digital-lending rules · DPDP Act · human approval before any money moves · full audit log

UNIQUE SELLING PROPOSITION · MARKET COMPARISON

USP: Munim predicts the cash gap, then acts

Capability	Paytm AI Soundbox [1]	PhonePe Business [7] [8]	Razorpay [9]	ONDC seller apps [10]	Munim (Paradox)
Core AI job	Answers and summaries	Pages, onboarding agent	Agentic payments, chat	Catalog and search	Forecasts and acts
Cash-flow forecast	Not announced	Not announced	Not announced	Not announced	14-day twin
Acts for merchant	Insights only	Page creation	Payment tasks	Listings	Collect, restock, promote, fund
Credit tied to forecast	Not announced	Not announced	Not announced	Not announced	Just-in-time, forecast-sized

Based on public announcements found up to Oct 2026. “Not announced” means we found no public launch, not that it cannot exist.

[1] BusinessToday: AI Soundbox launch
[2] Inc42: 1.5 Cr subscription merchants
[3] The Quint: CLSA on Soundbox and loans
[4] TechCrunch: Soundbox rental pushback
[5] Outlook Business: Deloitte MSME report
[6] Outlook Business: SIDBI credit gap
[7] PhonePe: SmartPages
[8] PhonePe: AI integration layer
[9] Razorpay: Agentic payments
[10] Tribune: Mystore Genie on ONDC

IMPACT AND BENEFITS

Value for merchants, Paytm and the economy

For merchants

- Fewer cash crunches, dues chased automatically
- Voice help in their own language
- Credit sized to real need
- Time saved on spreadsheets and calls

For Paytm

- More engaged Soundbox merchants
- Higher loan conversion from forecast-sized offers
- New premium AI plan revenue
- Fewer returned devices [4]

For the economy

- Eases the ₹30 lakh crore MSME credit gap, shop by shop [6]
- Moves MSMEs from digital payments (90%) to digital lending (18%) [6]
- Distributors paid on time via UPI links

Metrics to prove in the pilot: forecast error · dues recovered · cash-gap days · loan repayment · AI-plan retention. These are hypotheses to test, not claims.

BUSINESS MODEL

Four revenue streams on one existing device

01 · AI PLAN

Premium Munim

Paid tier on the Soundbox, priced by AI usage, in line with Paytm's token model [1]

02 · LENDING

Forecast-sized credit

Device merchants got 85% of loan disbursals (Q2 FY23); better offers widen that funnel [3]

03 · COMMERCE

Restock and offers

Small fee from distributors and brands on orders Munim places (hypothesis to test)

04 · RETENTION

Box that earns rent

Merchants return devices that feel like pure cost; Munim gives a reason to keep it [4]

PHASE 1 · DEMO

Software layer on existing Soundbox and data, built on synthetic data

PHASE 2 · PILOT

One city, kirana shops and cafés, measure the pilot metrics

PHASE 3 · SCALE

Roll out across the 1.5 Cr subscription merchant base [2]